

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Somatic Experiencing (SE) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

All ages | Brain-Based Fit: Moderate

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

Somatic Experiencing is a body-based approach to healing trauma. It works "bottom-up" — starting with the body and nervous system rather than thoughts and stories. The idea is that trauma gets "stuck" in the nervous system, and SE helps the brain complete the defensive responses (fight, flight, freeze) that got interrupted during the traumatic event. The child learns to notice and track body sensations, building the brain's capacity to regulate its own arousal. SE specifically avoids intense re-experiencing of trauma.

Caregiver Involvement:

Varies. Caregivers may be included in sessions or coached on how to support regulation at home. Not as consistently caregiver-involved as some other modalities on this list.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child has trauma-related symptoms that seem "stuck in the body" — startling, freezing, physical tension, unexplained pain
- Talk therapy or cognitive approaches haven't worked because your child can't access or describe their experience in words
- Your child has meltdowns or shutdowns that seem disproportionate to the trigger
- There is a trauma history but your child can't narrate it (common in early or preverbal trauma)

Brain-Based Consideration

:The body-based approach bypasses the cognitive demands that are challenging for brain-based differences. For children who carry both prenatal and postnatal trauma, SE offers a way to address the nervous system directly without requiring verbal processing. However, SE does require some interoceptive awareness — the ability to notice internal body sensations — which may be variable in children with brain-based differences.

1. Is what is written accurate?

☐

Yes

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No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Somatic Experiencing (SE)?



Thank you for your feedback!